

Wolfram|Alpha

A new service that hopes to make "all systematic knowledge immediately computable by anyone". Check it out!

No Windows 7 says US Army

Plans to upgrade all computers to Vista by December

Open source defeats Microsoft

Court fines Microsoft \$200 million for violating open source patent

country may not necessarily be due to change in consumer attitude or regulatory crackdown since these numbers are only relating to personal computer software piracy. A possible reason could be the availability of SaaS cloud services. And because OEMs are increasingly giving bundled software with PCs for which costs are recovered from the consumer at source. Whatever may be the reason, software companies still need to come up with an innovative way to battle the problem.

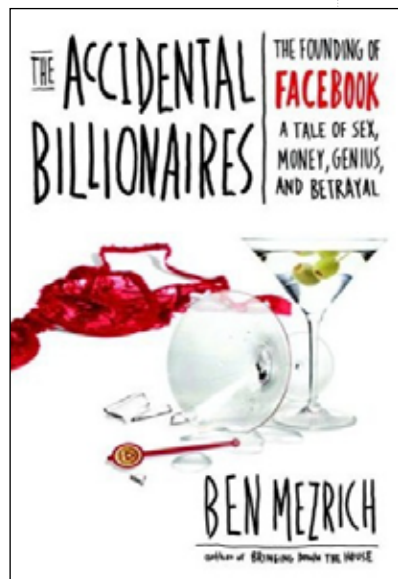
Perhaps taking a page from the music industry could be a possible solution. The music industry is now becoming more and more open to giving away free content, but is setting up viable and alternate revenue models at the same time.

called Think, which released HouseSystem, a web-based student portal that included a section called "The Universal Face Book" or "The Face Book." Zuckerberg then went on to form Facebook which is alleged to have been based on this concept. Besides, Greenspan also wrote a book called "Authoritas: One Student's Harvard Admissions and the Founding of the Facebook Era" which he was not able to market properly on Google because of trademark issues caused by the word Facebook being present in the title. So he went about trying to get the words un-trademarked so that he could use them. His argument was that he used the words first and in a similar concept at that.

That was until a settlement was reached. Now both parties have exchanged courtesies and Greenspan is sure to have got a hefty sum too. Exact figure that has changed hands is not known, but going by what the last guy who pointed a finger at Facebook got, the figure could well be close to \$65 million. This was apparently the settlement that ConnectU got when it said that Zuckerberg stole ConnectU's code and business plans for a social network. As per the terms of the settlement, Greenspan (Think) has agreed to abandon his efforts to get the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office to cancel the trademark issued to

Facebook in 2006.

Well, let's hope with this announcement peace is maintained in the social sphere for at least some time. It seems Zuckerberg had some legal spat with co-founder and fellow Harvard batchmate Eduardo Saverin too. If the story interests you perhaps you'd like to pick up a copy of "The Accidental Billionaires" due for release in July. The book's title slug goes something like this – "The founding of Facebook – A tale of sex, money, genius and betrayal."



Facebook settles a longstanding dispute

The pesky specter of Aaron Greenspan that has been plaguing Facebook for a long time has finally been put to rest. The dispute, which has finally reach a settlement was about the very existence of Facebook. The story is rather long and messy, but in a nutshell it goes something like this – Facebook founder Mark Zuckerberg and Aaron Greenspan studied together at Harvard. While perusing his academics, Greenspan founded a company

Books heading towards their Sci-Fi logical end

You know that concept we've come across in many science fiction books; about the sum total of human knowledge being available to all? No, not Wikipedia, more like the Encyclopedia Galactica.

This concept visualises all information ever created by mankind to be available to all people through devices that

tap into this great big source of data. However, for this concept to ever actualise, we'll have to go to those dusty old things. Err, what are they called? Books! That's right. For people to be able to access all this information stored in the form of books on shelves in libraries, they will have to be digitised. And it looks like the process is in full swing. The British Library in London has been putting to work four giant scanners and has nearly completed

digitising more than 1,00,000 books from the 19th century. The process took nearly two years and is quite interesting. A 21-MP camera photographs pages, while a robotic arm turns them. Google, too, is busy digitising millions of books for its book search tool and will easily exceed the British Library's project.

What about the tablet like Sci-Fi devices that catch information over the air for your ready viewing? They're here too. The latest of them is the Kindle DX from Amazon. It's got a screen that's almost 10-inches and can download books, periodicals, magazines and documents wirelessly with



support for 3G. The device is almost as thin as a magazine. Too bad it can't be rolled up, yet!. Currently, you can choose from over 2,85,000 books including the latest chart toppers. Books can be purchased over the air for about 10 dollars each, often this is

more expensive than printed books. The device itself is pretty expensive, retailing at \$489 on Amazon. So does this mean the death knell for good old paper and cardboard?

Certainly not until it all gets cheaper.

Apple Netbook may be around the corner

Netbooks are definitely the latest rage. Almost every PC manufacturer is offering products in this segment. Except, of course, Apple. This curious lack of any offering from the Mac maker and the current trend is prompting many an industry analyst to predict a device soon. Chances are that the announcement may even be made at Apple's Developers Conference in June. There are various speculative suggestions that this device may come with

